

ACARS provider found again, connected even when TELEX fails

The shared datalink router: the ACARS provider (Hoppie, BeyondATC, SayIntentions) looked for without end, followed once active, and the flight number connected when it answers

Branch	pr/29-datalink-acars-activation
Aircraft	A32NX and A380X (shared datalink router)
Commits	ba83c9b4b fix(datalink): keep looking for the ACARS provider and follow its availability
Base	upstream master
Status	CI checks pass; merged into develop (6d68cfd88); tested with BeyondATC (late start, close and restart) on 2026-09-29.

Purpose

Found flying with BeyondATC: a provider started late was never found and the flyPad settings were reset after 5 minutes; a flight number connection stopped the activation; a closed provider still showed connected; a TELEX failure left the ACARS provider unconnected.

Specification

State	Behaviour
Not active	ping every 5 s for 5 minutes, then once a minute; the flyPad settings are never changed
Active, no flight number	a ping once a minute checks the provider
Active, flight number	the polls (45 to 75 s) and the messages check it: no extra traffic
Provider lost	L:A32NX_ACARS_ACTIVE back to 0, fast retries again; the flight number connected when it answers
Flight number (re)connection	clears the flight number only: the activation goes on
TELEX failure	the ACARS provider is connected anyway; the TELEX failure is still returned

Tests

AcarsConnector.spec.ts (4): late provider, flight number while the provider is down, provider closed and started again, with and without a flight number.

PR description (from the PR draft)

From `pr-drafts/29-datalink-acars-activation.md`, section "Summary of Changes" onwards.

Summary of Changes

Found while flying with BeyondATC as the ACARS provider (shared datalink code: both aircraft):

- The activation pinged the provider every 5 s for 5 minutes, then **gave up and reset the flyPad settings** (ACARS provider to NONE, ATIS to VATSIM, METAR to MSFS): starting BeyondATC 6 minutes after the aircraft wiped the setup. It now keeps trying once a minute after the first 5 minutes and never changes the settings.
- A flight number connection starts with a disconnection, which **stopped the activation** in progress: a provider not answering at that moment was never found. A disconnection now only clears the flight number.
- When the provider answers late, the **flight number received before is connected** (callsign check, then polls).
- A provider **closed later** was never noticed (the flyPad kept "connected"). Once active, the provider is checked once a minute without a flight number (a ping) or by the polls and the messages sent with one (no extra traffic for Hoppie); when it stops answering, the ACARS is not active any more and the activation starts again, fast.
- With TELEX on, a TELEX connection failure **left the ACARS provider unconnected**. `Router.connect` now connects both and still returns the TELEX failure.

4 unit tests (`AcarsConnector.spec.ts`): a provider started 6 minutes late (settings untouched), a flight number connected while the provider is down, a provider closed and started again, with and without a flight number.

Cockpit API Changes

None (`L:A32NX_ACARS_ACTIVE` now also goes back to 0 when the provider stops answering).

Screenshots (if necessary)

TO ADD: flyPad ATSU/AOC page "waiting for connection" then connected.

References

- Hoppie ACARS technical notes (polling every 45 to 75 s), <https://www.hoppie.nl/acars/system/tech.html>
- BeyondATC ACARS server logs (localhost:57698) during the tests.

Discord username (if different from GitHub): **TO ADD**

Testing instructions

1. flyPad ATSU/AOC: ACARS provider BATC (or Hoppie), BeyondATC closed. Load the aircraft: "waiting for connection".
2. Start BeyondATC after 6 minutes: within a minute, connected; the provider setting is still BATC.
3. Enter a flight number, then close BeyondATC: within about a minute, "waiting for connection"; start it again: connected, and the flight number is connected again (BeyondATC log: ping with the flight number, then polls).
4. TELEX on with a flight number FBW's service refuses: the ACARS provider is still connected.
5. `npx vitest run fbw-common/src/systems/datalink/router/src/webinterfaces/AcarsConnector.spec.ts` (4 tests).